

TITLE

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(ACT 1 - Sequence 1)

BLACK

We hear the whining of plane turbines.

FADE IN:

INT. ECONOMY CLASS - KOREAN AIR - NIGHT

Close on RAPH, 25, with AirPods blocking the noise of the plane's engines.

He's on his phone, going through a chat that reads "Adriana" with a purple heart after the name.

On starred messages, he begins playing a voice message that she sent.

There's a gentle and longing look in his eyes the entire time the memo is playing.

ADRIANA (V.O.)

(in a strong
Ecuadorian accent)

Heyyy. I'm so excited to see you again Raph. Oh my god. Eleven months, sixteen days. It couldn't have come a single day too soon. I hope you miss me too. You better get all sweaty from wanting to see me. See you at Incheon in (rustling) fifteen hours. I love you.

EXT. INCHEON AIRPORT - AFTERNOON

A Korean Air plane lands.

We hear the sound of a busy subway station fading in. A bleep-like the one heard from Korean ticket reader-sounds once.

INT. KTX TRAIN - CONTINUOUS

Raph sits in an empty train. He's gripping suitcase to prevent it from moving too much.

The scenery outside the train rushes left to right.

ANNOUNCER (V.O.)
 (in Korean)
 Next stop. Hongik University.
 (in English)
 Next stop. Hongik University.

INT. HONGIK UNIVERSITY STATION - LATER

Ever-busy Hongdae Station. People aren't watching where they're going. Everyone's having conversations in Korean.

Raph navigates his luggage while trying not to bump into anyone.

GATES

While switching metro lines, Raph seemingly can't figure out how to get his thick suitcase past the ticket scanner. It's too narrow.

Some people are looking, but only one YOUNG KOREAN MAN tries helping Raph by leading him towards a wider gate meant for handicapped passengers. They don't understand each other, but Raph shows his gratitude while the young Korean man walks on.

RAPH
 (in Korean)
 Thank you.

YOUNG KOREAN MAN
Safe travels.
 (in English)
 Good.

EXT. MANGWON STATION - NIGHT

We see the entrance to Mangwon Station Exit 1. Next to it is an elevator door, from which Raph now emerges. He's on the phone.

EXT. MANGWON - SAME

The city is alive and loud.

Raph is walking down the alleys of this new neighborhood, yawning while on the phone with Adriana.

He passes a Korean woman handing out pamphlets and tissues, but ignores her.

RAPH

No I'm calling with my normal sim card. I'll get a Korean one tomorrow, first thing I'll do here.

(beat)

It would have made me really happy if you had picked me up from the airport, Addie.

(beat)

How is it too American? That's just the nickname for Adriana.

(beat)

I'm on my way to my new place in Mangwon. Felt good to be back in Hongdae. We should go to the place where we had our first date. That was near the station. What do you say?

(beat)

You're kidding me. Next week? No, I understand. Semester and all.

(beat)

Yes, Suwon isn't Seoul.

(beat)

I just returned to Korea after almost a year. Replayed your last voice memo over and over while I was in the plane. Now it feels like you don't even want to see me.

We hear five presses on a digital door lock as we

CUT TO:

INT. APARTMENT BUILDING - NIGHT

...followed by a door opening. Raph enters his new apartment and turns on the light.

Raph is sitting at the dining table, eating a dosirak meal kit.

His suitcase is opened and clothes are scattered across the clean floor. The place is silent aside from the running air conditioning.

EXT. GANGNAM STATION - NIGHT

Raph leaves exit 2 of Gangnam station and is approached by a man in his 40s. His English is good but he has an accent. Raph tries ignoring him but the man's pretty direct.

GANGNAM MAN
Where are you from?

RAPH
(avoidant)
Sorry?

GANGNAM MAN
Are you American?

RAPH
Yeah I'm from Oregon.

GANGNAM MAN
Oh. Very pretty. My wife is from
California.

RAPH
Awesome. I've never been there.

GANGNAM MAN
Do you have time Sunday?

RAPH
I'm pretty busy these days.

The man hands Raph a pamphlet. It looks like it's for a church in the Dongjak district.

GANGNAM MAN
It's free for everyone. We love
foreigners there, too. Many
foreigners come. Make friends?

RAPH
Sure, I'll check it out.

Raph keeps walking. He's not interested, but shoves the pamphlet into his breast pocket.

We see it says **Child of Light** on the front.

GANGNAM MAN
(in Korean)
You're so nice.

EXT. SINCHON STATION - EVENING

Raph is waiting in front of Exit 4 of Sinchon Station. He's looking left and right, frantically waiting. Koreans walk past him for a few seconds. Then Raph's eyes light up, he smiles and waves someone over. Enzo, 23, walks up to Raph and hugs him. He's about a head taller than Raph.

RAPH

Enzo.

ENZO

Raph, it's been too long. How are you?

RAPH

Starting to feel the jet lag.

ENZO

I know just what you need. The place is just down the street.

INT. BBQ RESTAURANT - LATER

Raph and Enzo are sitting at a table with a Korean barbecue grill between them. They're tossing meat on the grill like they're starving. They're drinking water and beers. The table is stacked with banchan, not a single inch of the counter top is visible.

ENZO

So what's your plan for the next twelve months? Not gonna fill it all with work, are you?

RAPH

Well, ideally, I get to spend as much time with Addie as possible.

ENZO

You're crazy for doing this.

RAPH

How is it crazy?

ENZO

You two haven't seen each other in so long. Aren't you scared that, I don't know, the vibe's different now?

RAPH

You're saying that because of how things ended with Su.

ENZO

Know how it started to fall apart? She distanced herself.

RAPH

It won't fall apart. And it's not crazy. I love her-we love each other.

ENZO

What's she up to then?

RAPH

College. You should know how hard it is to learn Korean. How's that going, by the way?

ENZO

Oh, right. I'm gonna drop that.

RAPH

You're going home?

ENZO

No. Korea's pretty much my new home, anyway. I'll change my visa. Open a business here.

RAPH

Business?

ENZO

Yeah. Selling beauty products.

RAPH

I...uh. Wow. Happy for you, Enzo.

Enzo freezes. He looks out the window.

ENZO

Wait, what does Addie look like again?

Raph turns around to see what Enzo's talking about.

A group of people is walking by. Men and women, Koreans and some foreigners. Some of the men are wearing yellow ties. At the front, we catch a glimpse of who appears to be Adriana.

RAPH

What the...

Raph gets up and makes his way to the door. The group has moved on by now. We follow him peeking out of the restaurant, looking to the side.

EXT. BBQ RESTAURANT

A busy street, countless pedestrians. Raph stares down where he thought he saw Addie. It's like they vanished.

INT. CAFÉ - DAY

Raph being bored at work. There are several messages from his coworkers he hasn't answered yet. He chugs his coffee.

INT. MOM'S TOUCH - DAY

Raph eating inside an empty Mom's touch restaurant. There's a sense of remoteness to his existence in here.

EXT. SHOPPING MALL - LATER

Raph walking around by himself. He's looking at neatly dressed female mannequins.

He looks over to the flower shop next to him.

EXT. SUWON UNIVERSITY DORMS - AFTERNOON

Raph standing in front of the dorm with a bouquet of roses. He's on his phone. It's ringing. No one picks up. He leaves a voice message.

RAPH

Hey, Addie. I wanted to surprise you.
Guess you aren't at the dorm right
now. Let me know what you're up to.
Love you.

INT. MAKGEOLLI BAR - NIGHT

Wooden facades and private booths surround groups of intoxicated college students. Red cheeks and embarrassed laughter no matter where you look.

Raph and Enzo are sitting with DONG-MIN, sharing drinks and banchan. Enzo is in the midst of sharing a story. The other two are captivated.

ENZO

I've been the happiest I've ever
been.

DONG-MIN

But you loved her. Every
night I'd see you two on
campus all ㅋㅋㅋㅋ / lovey
dovey.

RAPH

Yeah.

ENZO

You two don't know about the hardships that come with that. I just felt... caged.

DONG-MIN

It's very ironic. You left your girlfriend and now visit Korea.

(to Raph)

You came to Korea to be back with your girlfriend.

RAPH

(points at Dong-Min with his cup)

And you work for the president.

Raph drinks as Dong-min tries to downplay his success.

DONG-MIN

I'm just part of the cabinet. Lower cabinet. But I'll get up there.

ENZO

Nepo Baby.

DONG-MIN

(in Korean)

Not at all.

ENZO

Your parents are rich as fuck, man.

They laugh together. The scene feels like three best friends hanging out like they do every weekend. Impossible to tell it's been years since they last saw each other.

ENZO (cont'd)

(clears throat)

I did love her. Being with her was the second happiest time of my life.

RAPH

Dude.

DONG-MIN

You regret it?

ENZO

No, I don't regret it. I just miss her from time to time.

DONG-MIN

And then you go clubbing. Next time you drunk-call me, your number goes straight to spam.

ENZO

Well, you're single but never come with me.

DONG-MIN

Bad look on a politician.

ENZO

Fuck it. Let's drink. Before I start crying from loneliness.

Enzo grabs the makgeolli bottle. Dong-Min holds out his bowl as Raph refills it for him. Next Raph does the same as Dong-Min. Raph goes for the makgeolli bottle, but Enzo is already refilling his own bowl.

DONG-MIN

You still do it wrong.

Enzo shrugs.

INT. CAFÉ - DAY

A typical Holly's Coffee like any other in Seoul. We hear ice being stirred. Koreans around them are talking at a high volume. There are electronic sounds from the ordering system.

Now we see Addie is the one moving around a straw in her Americano.

Raph only looks at her, but he's not happy. The mood's rotten.

RAPH

I still can't believe it. It's been so long.

ADRIANA

Yeah.

RAPH

Aren't you the least bit happy to see me?

Adriana keeps stirring her coffee.

RAPH (cont'd)

Tell me what's going on. Please.

ADRIANA

I can't-

RAPH
You can't tell me?

ADRIANA
God. Let me finish. I can't, Raph. I
can't do this.

RAPH
Do what?

ADRIANA
(stops stirring)
We have to break up.

Raph's silence weighs down the room. His breathing speeds
up.

RAPH
You're kidding me.

ADRIANA
I'm sorry, Raph. I really am.

RAPH
You've got to be fucking kidding me,
Addie.

ADRIANA
Why do you keep calling me that?

RAPH
Because it's normal to give your
girlfriend a cute nickname. For
fuck's sake, I love you.

Raph slams the table a little too hard.

ADRIANA
I thought I loved you, too.

RAPH
And you waited until I moved across
the globe to tell me?

ADRIANA
I know this is fucked up.

RAPH
Why now?

ADRIANA
Sorry, this- I have to go.

Adriana gets up. Raph tries to stop her, but the table's wobbly and he spills his coffee, drawing attention of other guests. Adriana hurries up to get out.

RAPH
Addie, come back.